

Redistricting and Political Communication: Evidence from U.S. House Members on Twitter*

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Draft — please do not circulate

Abstract

[One paragraph: research question, the redistricting natural experiment, the tweet corpus and measurement approach, headline finding.]

1 Introduction

[Motivation: electoral incentives and representation; why redistricting is a useful shock to constituency composition; preview of design, data, and findings; contribution relative to existing work.]

2 Background and Related Work

[Literature on redistricting and legislator behavior; position-taking and home style; text-as-data studies of congressional communication.]

3 Redistricting as a Natural Experiment

[Institutional background of the 2020–2022 cycle; timing of map proposals and enactment by state; why boundary changes are plausibly exogenous to an individual incumbent’s communication strategy; definition of treatment (change in district partisanship) and control (unchanged PVI).]

4 Data

[Tweet corpus of members of Congress; Cook PVI by district (Kaslovsky and Kistner, 2025); legislator metadata and Twitter handle matching; sample construction and descriptive statistics.]

5 Empirical Strategy

[Specification: outcome measures derived from tweets; comparison of treated and control incumbents around map enactment dates; identification assumptions and threats (member–member pairings, retirements, strategic timing).]

**[Acknowledgements, funding, and disclaimers go here.]*

6 Results

[Main estimates; dynamics around redistricting events; heterogeneity by party, seniority, and magnitude of PVI change.]

7 Robustness

[Alternative outcome definitions; placebo dates; excluding court-overturned maps (NY, OH); sensitivity to sample restrictions.]

8 Discussion and Conclusion

[Interpretation, limitations, and directions for future work.]